

Facilitator Kit • Train-the-Trainer Guide: Becoming a Hackles Mentor

Trust your hackles. Pause • Check • Tell.

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FIELD COPY



PLATE I. The six strands, hand-inked, in the order the lessons take them.

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OCTOBER 2026

CONTENTS

Contents

About Hackles 3

1. What a Hackles Mentor is (and is not) 5

2. The Hackles learning path: five levels 6

3. Who makes a good mentor 8

4. The 4-session Mentor Course (8 hours) 9

5. The 10 non-negotiables (fidelity checklist) 12

6. The facilitation rubric: Is the training fun, safe, skill-based? 13

7. The Mentor Circle (monthly, 45 minutes) 15

8. Running your first training: a 6-week launch plan 16

9. Facilitation skills for non-experts 17

10. Handling hard moments (quick guide) 18

11. Licensing, attribution and ethics 19

12. Growing a mentor team across a district 20

13. Self-care for mentors 20

14. Certificates and recognition 20

Hackles Facilitator Kit, Document 9 of 10. How a teacher, counselor, librarian or tech coordinator grows from workshop participant to Hackles Mentor, and then helps train others. Includes a 4-session mentor course, competency checklists, a facilitation rubric and the monthly Mentor Circle.

[Logo: Hackles]

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No student accounts, no student data collected, ever.

About Hackles

HACKLES IS A FREE K-12 online safety and cybersecurity kit (quillsup.org) made by a small group of educators and security practitioners. Its core idea is "hackles": the feeling on the back of your neck when something is off. It teaches children to notice that feeling and act on it: Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell. Because the kit is free, it spreads through people, not purchases. **You** are how it spreads. Feedback and questions: [CONTACT: to be added].

Pathway note (adult-facing only). Hackles is the first step on a learning path that continues with free resources such as picoCTF and CYBER.ORG. This note is for adults and is never shown to students.

Contents

1. What a Hackles Mentor is (and is not)
2. The Hackles learning path: five levels
3. Who makes a good mentor
4. The 4-session Mentor Course (8 hours)
5. The 10 non-negotiables (fidelity checklist)
6. The facilitation rubric: Is the training fun, safe, skill-based?
7. The Mentor Circle (monthly, 45 minutes)
8. Running your first training: a 6-week launch plan
9. Facilitation skills for non-experts
10. Handling hard moments (quick guide)
11. Licensing, attribution and ethics
12. Growing a mentor team across a district
13. Self-care for mentors
14. Certificates and recognition

01 What a Hackles Mentor is (and is not)

Try this now (5 minutes): read Micro-PD Session 1 once, aloud, and decide who you would ask to co-lead it with you. A mentor is made by running one 15-minute session, not by reading this guide.

A HACKLES MENTOR IS

- A colleague who has **taught Hackles lessons** and enjoys helping others do it.
- Someone who can **run a 15-minute micro-PD** and, with support, a 90-minute or half-day workshop.
- A **coach** who uses the rubric "Is the lesson fun, safe, skill-based?" with warmth.
- A **safe adult** who listens when a colleague has a worry.
- A **bridge** between teachers, the counselor and the principal.

A HACKLES MENTOR IS NOT

- A cybersecurity expert. You do not need to know how networks work. You need to know the routine and the rules.
- A lawyer. You never give legal advice. You say "[VERIFY] with our administrator and counsel."
- A therapist or investigator. You listen, reassure, report and hand off.
- An evaluator. Mentoring is separate from evaluation. You never report on a colleague's teaching to administration without that colleague's consent. [VERIFY with your contract.]
- Alone. Mentors work in pairs and in a circle.

TIME COMMITMENT

ACTIVITY	TYPICAL TIME
Mentor Course	8 hours over 4 weeks
Preparing and running one micro-PD session	30 minutes prep plus 15 minutes
Observing a colleague (pre, observe, debrief)	About 45 minutes
Monthly Mentor Circle	45 minutes
Co-facilitating a half-day workshop	4 hours plus 2 hours prep

If your school can offer **release time or a stipend**, do. [VERIFY any funding rules.]

02 The Hackles learning path: five levels

LEVEL	NAME	WHAT YOU CAN DO	HOW YOU GET THERE
1	Participant	Say and use the routine, respond to a child who tells you something, and know your help map	Attend the 90-Minute or Half-Day Workshop
2	Practitioner	Teach Hackles lessons with confidence, including a sensitive lesson with counselor support	Teach at least 3 lessons (including 1 in a band you have not taught); be observed once with H13; attend 3 micro-PD sessions
3	Hackles Mentor	Lead micro-PD sessions; observe and coach colleagues; run a Mentor Circle	Complete the Mentor Course (Section 4); co-lead two micro-PD sessions; do two peer observations; pass the teach-back
4	Lead Facilitator	Run the 90-Minute and Half-Day Workshops, and Parent Night	Co-facilitate a workshop with a Lead Facilitator; run one with a safety partner; be observed with the rubric in Section 6
5	Trainer of Mentors	Run the Mentor Course for other buildings or districts	Lead the Mentor Course once with support; be observed; join the cross-school Mentor Circle

COMPETENCY CHECKLISTS

Level 1 Participant

- ☐ I can say the routine and do the four hand signals.
- ☐ I can say "Thank you for telling me. This is not your fault. You are not in trouble."
- ☐ I know three things never to do in a disclosure (promise secrecy, ask "why did you," look at an intimate image).
- ☐ I filled in my Help Map (H7).
- ☐ I made one commitment (H15).

Level 2 Practitioner

- ☐ I have taught 3 lessons using Hook 2, Activity 8, Discuss 3, Takeaway 2.
- ☐ I used the calm opening and closing.
- ☐ I sent the pre-notice and the counselor heads-up for a sensitive lesson, or watched a colleague do so.
- ☐ I was observed once and got two glows and a grow.
- ☐ I observed a colleague once.

Level 3 Hackles Mentor

- ☐ I completed the Mentor Course.
- ☐ I led two micro-PD sessions and was rated "Got it" on most items on the facilitation rubric.
- ☐ I observed and coached two colleagues with warmth and specifics.

- ☐ I can lead a disclosure role-play with safety rails (with a safety partner).
- ☐ I know the 10 non-negotiables by heart.
- ☐ I know the limits of my role.

Level 4 Lead Facilitator

- ☐ I co-facilitated a half-day workshop.
- ☐ I ran one with a safety partner, on time.
- ☐ I handled a "teacher shares an incident" situation (or practiced it).
- ☐ I ran Parent Night with a counselor.
- ☐ I was observed using the rubric in Section 6.

Level 5 Trainer of Mentors

- ☐ I led the Mentor Course once.
- ☐ I trained at least three mentors who then ran sessions.
- ☐ I joined the cross-school Mentor Circle.
- ☐ I helped improve the kit by sending feedback: [CONTACT: to be added].

03 Who makes a good mentor

Look for people who:

- **Enjoy teaching adults** and will not talk for an hour when five minutes will do.
- **Listen** and stay calm. A mentor's calm is contagious.
- **Respect confidentiality** without fail.
- **Admit what they do not know** and say "let's find out."
- **Like fun:** games, props, a silly hat.
- **Care about every child**, including the quiet ones and the ones who are hard to love.
- Are **trusted** by colleagues.
- Can **receive feedback** with grace.

Mentors can be teachers, paraprofessionals, librarians, counselors, tech coordinators, instructional coaches or administrators. The best mentor teams have **more than one role** (for example a counselor and a teacher, or a librarian and a tech coordinator).

How to invite someone: "I noticed how you handled the Phish Derby. Would you consider helping lead the next staff session? I'll coach you."

04 The 4-session Mentor Course (8 hours)

FOUR SESSIONS OF TWO hours each, spaced over four weeks. Run by a Lead Facilitator or Trainer of Mentors, with a counselor for Session B. Small group (4 to 12 people). **The course models the very methods it teaches: movement, games, role-play, peer feedback.**

BEFORE THE COURSE

- ☐ Participants have attended the Half-Day or 90-Minute Workshop.
- ☐ Each participant has the Facilitator Kit and the Teacher Support Pack.
- ☐ A counselor is booked for Session B.
- ☐ Rooms, materials and snacks are ready.

SESSION A (2 HOURS): FACILITATION FUNDAMENTALS AND MODEL-THE-METHOD

Outcome: Mentors can run a 15-minute micro-PD that is fun, safe and skill-based.

MIN	ACTIVITY	METHOD MODELED
0:00-0:10	Welcome and Hackles Up check-in. One word about how you feel about leading others.	Opening ritual
0:10-0:25	The shape of a session: Hook 2, Activity 8, Discuss 3, Takeaway 2. Teach it with a 2-minute demo of Micro-PD Session 1.	Modeled lesson
0:25-0:45	Build a hook: each mentor writes a 30-second hook for a micro-PD session. Share in trios.	Peer feedback
0:45-1:05	"Pull back the curtain": name the teaching move after each activity. Mentors practice saying it.	Metacognition
1:05-1:15	Break	
1:15-1:50	Practice facilitation: each mentor leads 3 minutes of a Micro-PD Session activity. The others play teachers. Feedback: two glows and a grow (H12).	Micro-teach
1:50-2:00	Takeaway and homework: read Micro-PD Session 3 and prepare to lead the Hook and Activity.	Closing

Homework: run one 5-minute "mini-session" with a colleague (any activity). Write one thing you learned.

SESSION B (2 HOURS): SAFETY, DISCLOSURE AND THE HARD MOMENTS

Counselor present for the whole session.

MIN	ACTIVITY	METHOD MODELED
0:00-0:10	Welcome and agreements (fictional only, pass allowed, step out allowed, traffic-light cards)	Safety rails
0:10-0:30	The First 10 Minutes in depth. The counselor walks through H6, the Disclosure and Incident Guide, and the honest limit on secrecy. Q and A.	Expert voice

MIN	ACTIVITY	METHOD MODELED
0:30-1:05	Mentor-led disclosure role-play. Mentors practice leading the Segment 6 role-play: the framing, demo, traffic-light cards and de-role. One mentor leads, one plays the safety partner, one observes with a checklist. Rotate.	Role-play with rails
1:05-1:15	Break	
1:15-1:50	When a teacher shares their own incident. Practice the script from the Facilitator Guide Section 8 in trios. Each person plays the facilitator, the teacher and the observer.	Role-play
1:50-2:00	Self-care and takeaway. The counselor leads a breath. Every mentor names a person they will talk to if they need support.	Closing

Homework: fill in a personal "Safety Plan for Mentors": who is my safety partner? what is my reporting route? who is my debrief person? [VERIFY]

SESSION C (2 HOURS): COACHING WITH THE RUBRIC

Outcome: Mentors can observe and coach with "Is the lesson fun, safe, skill-based?"

MIN	ACTIVITY	METHOD MODELED
0:00-0:10	Opening game: Hackles Simon Says.	Movement
0:10-0:30	Learn the rubric from the Peer Coaching Guide (Section 3). Rate three written mini-scenarios (for example, a Hook that lasts 6 minutes). Compare ratings.	Calibration
0:30-1:00	Live observation practice. Two mentors teach 5-minute speed lessons (MT cards). The rest observe with H13.	Observation
1:00-1:10	Break	
1:10-1:40	Feedback practice: each mentor gives two glows and a grow to the teacher, using the scripts in the Peer Coaching Guide (Section 8). Practice the Safety Slip script.	Role-play
1:40-1:55	PLC agendas: look at the six PLC agendas. Choose one to lead.	Planning
1:55-2:00	Takeaway and homework: observe one colleague (with permission) using H13 and give feedback.	Closing

SESSION D (2 HOURS): PRACTICUM AND TEACH-BACK

Outcome: Mentors co-lead a micro-PD session and pass the teach-back.

MIN	ACTIVITY
0:00-0:10	Opening and sharing homework: one thing I learned from observing
0:10-1:10	Teach-back, in groups of four. Each mentor leads the Hook and Activity (10 minutes) of a micro-PD session of their choice (Session 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 7 or 9), then gets 3 minutes of feedback from the group: $4 \times 13 = 52$ minutes, plus 8 for transitions. A Lead Facilitator observes one group with the rubric in Section 6 (with more than four mentors, add a Lead Facilitator or run Session D twice). The full 15-minute run happens in the mentor's own building, where it is observed.
1:10-1:20	Break
1:20-1:50	Rubric feedback: each mentor receives two glows and a grow from the Lead Facilitator against the Section 6 rubric and names one change for their first building session.

MIN	ACTIVITY
1:50-2:00	Next steps: each mentor schedules the first micro-PD session in their building. Celebrate (certificates).

AFTER THE COURSE

- Each mentor co-leads two micro-PD sessions with a colleague before leading alone.
- Each mentor observes two colleagues (with H13).
- Each mentor joins the Mentor Circle (Section 7).

05 The 10 non-negotiables (fidelity checklist)

THESE ARE THE RULES that protect children and keep the program trustworthy. A mentor never trades these away for convenience, a good laugh or an eager audience.

#	NON-NEGOTIABLE	WHY
1	No scare tactics. No alarming statistics or frightening stories as hooks.	Fear does not protect; skills do.
2	No demonstrations of attacks. We teach recognition and response.	We do not teach harm.
3	Fictional cases only. Nobody tells stories about real children.	Privacy, dignity and safety.
4	Pass is always allowed; stepping out needs no explanation.	Trauma-informed practice.
5	The honest limit on secrecy is stated. We never promise secrecy we cannot keep.	Honesty protects trust.
6	A counselor is involved in every sensitive lesson and in every disclosure role-play.	Safety and support.
7	"Never your fault" and "tell, no trouble" are said in every session and lesson.	Shame is the biggest obstacle.
8	[VERIFY] flags are respected. We confirm laws, numbers and policies locally.	Accuracy.
9	No student accounts and no student data. We do not add tools that collect them.	Privacy.
10	No marketing to children. Pathway notes appear only in adult-facing materials. Credit and license are kept.	Integrity.

Use this list at the start of every Mentor Circle: "Anyone have a non-negotiable they want to talk through?"

06 The facilitation rubric: Is the training fun, safe, skill-based?

THIS IS THE PEER Coaching rubric adapted for facilitators of adult training.

Use it when you observe a micro-PD, workshop or Parent Night.

Rating key: N = Not yet, G = Getting there, Y = Got it.

FUN

LOOK-FOR	EVIDENCE	N G Y
F1. Within 3 minutes, most participants are moving, talking or hands-on.		
F2. Humor and energy are warm and inclusive. The facilitator uses a prop, a game or a silly voice.		
F3. Participants have roles (captain, reader, observer), not just listening.		
F4. The pace is brisk. Segments end on time.		

SAFE

LOOK-FOR	EVIDENCE	N G Y
S1. No scare tactics or shaming.		
S2. Group agreements are stated. Pass and step-out are offered.		
S3. Content is fictional. No real stories.		
S4. For sensitive content, the safety partner is present, rails are used, and de-role is done.		
S5. The honest limit on secrecy is stated when relevant.		
S6. The facilitator handled a real disclosure or incident correctly (if one occurred).		
S7. [VERIFY] flags are mentioned, not ignored.		

SKILL-BASED

LOOK-FOR	EVIDENCE	N G Y
K1. One clear skill is practiced by participants.		
K2. The session ends with one takeaway and Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell.		
K3. The facilitator "pulls back the curtain" and names the teaching move.		
K4. Participants can use the skill by Friday.		

FACILITATION CRAFT

LOOK-FOR	EVIDENCE	N G Y
C1. Scripts are read in a natural voice.		
C2. The facilitator says "I do not know, let's find out" when needed.		
C3. Dominant voices are managed; quiet voices are invited.		
C4. Time is managed with the chime, not shouting.		
C5. Access needs are anticipated (seated options, large print, interpreter).		

Using the rubric: two glows and a grow, as always. No scores are compared. Observation is for growth.

07 The Mentor Circle (monthly, 45 minutes)

A MENTOR CIRCLE KEEPS mentors sharp, supported and connected. Hold it monthly in-building or across several schools.

AGENDA

MIN	SEGMENT	WHAT HAPPENS
0-5	Opener	Hackles Up signal and a one-word check-in. Read one non-negotiable aloud.
5-15	Win and worry	Each mentor shares one win and one worry (no identifying details). The circle responds with "Thank you. Here's an idea."
15-30	Practice	Choose one: a role-play (a teacher shares an incident), a micro-teach of a new lesson, or a hard-question practice (using the Teacher FAQ). Use fictional scenarios only.
30-38	Share a resource	One mentor shares a tool, a script, a game they tried or a [VERIFY] they resolved.
38-43	Plan	Each mentor names one thing they will do before the next circle.
43-45	Takeaway and pledge	A one-sentence takeaway. The Hackles pledge.

CIRCLE GROUND RULES

- Confidential. What we share about teachers stays here. (**Exception:** if a child may be in danger, we follow policy.)
- No student names. No teacher names without permission.
- Practice, don't preach.
- Laugh.
- Support each other's wellbeing.

PRACTICE SCENARIOS (ALL FICTIONAL)

1. A teacher interrupts the workshop to say the whole program is "scaremongering."
2. A teacher in the role-play breaks down and says "That happened to my niece."
3. A principal wants you to share who is struggling.
4. A parent at Parent Night says "Tell us the scary stuff."
5. A teacher wants to demonstrate how to hack a classmate's account "so they get it."
6. The counselor cannot come to the disclosure block.
7. A colleague asks you to share your observation notes with the principal.
8. A volunteer wants to share a real story about a child they know.

For each: what do you say? Who do you call? What do you not do?

08 Running your first training: a 6-week launch plan

WEEK	WHAT	NOTES
1	Choose your format and partner. Micro-PD Session 1 is the easiest first step. Find a co-lead (ideally a counselor).	Read the Micro-PD file
1	Check your policies with your administrator: reporting route, notice, opt-out, PD credit. [VERIFY]	Fill in H7
2	Prepare. Print handouts. Practice scripts out loud. Recruit a Phisher if you will run a Derby.	Rehearse for 30 minutes
3	Run Micro-PD Session 1 (15 minutes). Collect exit slips.	Use the rubric afterward
4	Ask for feedback. Invite a Lead Facilitator to observe Session 2 or 3.	Two glows and a grow
5	Run Session 2 or 3. Add a humorous prop.	Take notes on timing
6	Reflect and plan. What worked? What do you want to try? Plan the next three sessions.	Join the Mentor Circle

Make it fun. Bring a prop. Name the teams. Keep a scoreboard. Remember: if it is not fun, we are not done coaching.

09 Facilitation skills for non-experts

THE FIVE HABITS

1. **Start with a hook, not a slide.** A question, a prop, a laugh.
2. **Talk less than five minutes at a time.** Then get people moving, talking or making something.
3. **Ask, don't tell.** "What did you notice?" works better than "Here is what to notice."
4. **Pull back the curtain.** Name the teaching move out loud so teachers can steal it.
5. **End with one takeaway and the signals.**

SCRIPTS FOR COMMON MOMENTS

MOMENT	SAY
You do not know the answer	"I do not know. Let's find out. I'll write it on the Parking Lot and get back to you by [date]."
Someone dominates	"Thank you. I would like to hear from someone who has not spoken yet."
Someone challenges the program	"I hear you. Tell me more about your concern." (Then listen. Then: "Here's what the kit says about that.")
A legal question	"I'm not a lawyer. Let me get you an answer from [administrator or counsel]. [VERIFY]"
A participant is upset	Pause. Offer the Reset Corner. Safety partner steps over.
Someone shares a real incident	See the Facilitator Guide, Section 8: thank, pause, privately, honest limit, no probing, safety partner, follow-up in 24 hours.
Time is short	Use the flex plan; never cut the agreements, the de-role or the H6 review.
Energy is low	Stand up, Simon Says, a new voice, a new music track.

FUN ON PURPOSE: A MENTOR'S TOOLKIT

- A silly hat, a stuffed toy "Hackle," a pickle trophy.
- A chime for transitions.
- A scoreboard on the wall.
- A "Phisher" cameo.
- Team names (The Hackle Hecklers, Pause Palm Pirates).
- A 90-second movement break.
- Stickers.

WHAT NOT TO DO

- Do not read slides aloud.
- Do not lecture for more than five minutes.
- Do not embarrass anyone.
- Do not take over an incident or a conversation.
- Do not promise outcomes.
- Do not put anyone on the spot to share personal experience.

10 Handling hard moments (quick guide)

SITUATION	IMMEDIATE MOVE	FOLLOW-UP
A participant shares a personal or student incident	Thank, pause the group, move privately with the safety partner, state the honest limit	Check in within 24 hours; follow the Disclosure Guide if a child may be involved
A participant becomes visibly distressed	Offer the Reset Corner and water; the safety partner steps over	Private check-in later
A participant misuses the role-play (real story, laughing at the cards)	Show red: "Let's pause. Let's use the card."	Short private word if needed
A participant demands a hacking demo	"We teach recognition and response, not attacks."	Offer picoCTF or CYBER.ORG for their own learning
A participant says "kids already know all this"	"Some do. Do they know what to say to an adult? Let's find out together."	Offer an observation
An administrator asks about a teacher's participation	"I keep that confidential. I can share the group's themes."	Document the boundary
A teacher reports a possible harm to a child	Do not investigate. Follow the reporting route and the Disclosure Guide immediately.	Document facts only
A teacher teaches a sensitive lesson without notice	Talk privately and kindly; involve the counselor	Revisit the timeline
You are exhausted	Hand off to a co-mentor; talk to your debrief person	Adjust your schedule

11 Licensing, attribution and ethics

LICENSE AND ATTRIBUTION

- Hackles is licensed **CC BY-NC 4.0**: free to print, share and adapt for non-commercial use with credit. Use the credit and copyright lines from the title page. [VERIFY with counsel]
- **Non-commercial** means you do not sell Hackles materials or charge for training that uses them. If your district pays you, or you wish to charge outside participants, check with counsel whether this fits the license. [VERIFY]
- **Keep the credit line and license line** on materials you share.
- If you adapt materials (a different language, a local help map, a school logo), keep the child-safety content, disclosure boxes and [VERIFY] flags intact, and say that you adapted them.
- Do not edit scripts in ways that remove the sensitive-lesson safeguards.

ETHICS FOR MENTORS

- **Confidentiality.** What teachers tell you about their practice and their lives stays confidential, except where a child may be in danger and the law or policy requires action. [VERIFY]
- **Dignity.** Treat every colleague as a capable professional.
- **No student data.** Do not collect names, accounts, scores or device details. Do not accept student data from others.
- **No marketing to children.** The pathway note belongs in adult-facing materials only.
- **Honesty.** Mark uncertain facts as [VERIFY]. Correct errors quickly.
- **Inclusion.** Swap names and examples so everyone is represented; use "a grown-up you trust."
- **Safety first.** If a child may be in danger, follow the reporting route before anything else.
- **Humility.** You are not the expert on everything.

FEEDBACK TO THE HACKLES TEAM

PLEASE SHARE WHAT WORKED, what did not, and any corrections. [CONTACT: to be added]. Tell us the [VERIFY] items you resolved locally so that the kit can improve.

12 Growing a mentor team across a district

STEP	WHAT	WHO
1	Pilot in two or three buildings with one mentor each	District coordinator
2	Share the Principal Implementation Checklist with each principal	District coordinator
3	Hold a cross-school Mentor Circle monthly or quarterly	Trainer of Mentors
4	Collect adult feedback (see the Facilitator Evaluation and Certificates file). No student data.	Mentors
5	Create a shared folder of improved lesson notes and the one-page lesson-study write-ups	District coordinator
6	Offer the Mentor Course each fall to new volunteers	Trainer of Mentors
7	Recognize mentors publicly with certificates and a thank-you at a board meeting	District leader
8	Plan succession: each mentor trains a successor within two years	Each mentor

Volunteers and community partners. Parents, older students and community volunteers can help with Hackles Day, station hosting and Parent Night. All volunteers follow your district's vetting and supervision rules. [VERIFY] They do not receive disclosures: if a volunteer hears something, they stay calm, thank the child, and bring in a staff member immediately.

13 Self-care for mentors

MENTORING ON THESE TOPICS can carry weight. Take care of yourself.

- Have a **debrief person** (a counselor, a trusted colleague) and use them.
- Know your **EAP** and use it. [VERIFY]
- **Say no** when you are overloaded. Pass a session to a co-mentor.
- If you are a **survivor** yourself, ask a colleague to lead the sensitive parts. You never have to prove anything.
- **Rest and laugh.** The Mentor Circle should be restorative.
- **Celebrate.** Keep a "Win Wall" of notes from teachers.

14 Certificates and recognition

CERTIFICATES FOR EACH LEVEL and for completing the Mentor Course are in the Facilitator Evaluation and Certificates file. Present them at a staff meeting, with applause and the pickle trophy.

Educational guidance, not legal advice. Consult your administrator and counsel.
[VERIFY]